

How much better or worse is using ChatGPT for the environment than other causes such as eating meat or private jets?

Posted by u/benedictclive_x • 0 points • 8 comments

I heard AI is bad for the environment but relative to other things, how bad?

Comments

u/Ok_Molasses9660 • 1 points • 2025-11-26 02:53 UTC

sidenote, im against the constant integration of AI into everyday online life, including google search, whatsapp, copilot and freaking adobe acrobat reader when I DON'T need it. i'm sure it consumes electricity, it's annoying, and it's clear they want to make AI as much a part of our routines as possible so that we can't live without it and will pay to keep it in our lives

Like doordash/ubereats

u/ladz • 3 points • 2025-11-26 01:57 UTC

This discussion about "AI uses xyz water", "AI wrecks the planet dont use it" etc are the result of the industry itself trying to deflect blame for building giant datacenters using fossil energy sources, cooling that wrecks estuaries and rivers, and wasting the heat. Computers are heaters. They *could* be located centrally and provide district heating, or otherwise utilize it for good instead of heating waterways and killing aquatic life.

It's not you destroying nature, it's corporations. Don't let them avoid the blame.

u/BloodJackson • 1 points • 2025-11-25 22:52 UTC

How much is hats

u/TheGanzor • 1 points • 2025-11-26 01:28 UTC

Hat mouse?

u/P5000PowerLoader • 2 points • 2025-11-25 22:33 UTC

how far down the rabbit hole do you want to go?

What was the environmental cost of building the data centre where the AI lives?

all the infrastructure between your device and it?

This is why all environmental initiatives look good at face value..

u/HowlsDigit8888 • 1 points • 2025-11-25 22:28 UTC

I haven't really seen evidence using it is the problem so much as paying for it. I wish I never paid for data center in the past, that's what actually helped fund data center scaling and stuff.

When I use chat bots without paying for them, I'm not really the one funding or encouraging anyone to do any damage

u/Abridged-Escherichia • 6 points • 2025-11-25 22:23 UTC

Meat and private jets are much more carbon intensive than AI chatbots (like orders of magnitude more).

However both of those were already factored into emissions, AI is an unexpected addition.

u/archpawn • 1 points • 2025-11-25 22:22 UTC

I'm not sure how much has changed since [this](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>) was written, but I doubt it could have gotten that much worse. A ChatGPT prompt uses about as much energy as running the microwave for one second. As for water use, a sheet of paper takes as much water as 2,550 prompts. That page has a lot more comparisons if you want to look into the details, but the short answer is that ChatGPT is trivial compared to other things people take for granted.